



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Hope Preparatory School
School Website: <https://hopeprepschool.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Hope Preparatory School NC 28504 presents a robust classical Christian program with explicit religious foundations, a clearly articulated classical purpose, a curriculum built on the liberal arts, and pedagogy that foregrounds memory, Socratic discussion, and disciplined rhetoric. Public materials emphasize a Christ-centered, God-centered frame, daily worship and Bible integration, Great Books and Great Conversation, Latin from early grades, and a strong parental-partnership model. Across six classical criteria, the school demonstrates strong alignment with classical objectives and methods, with little or no evidence of modern non-classical signals.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Key insights: - Religious and metaphysical foundations are explicit: God-centered or Christ-centered framing, biblical worldview, and a formal Statement of Faith. - Purpose and goal stress formation, virtue, wisdom, and a teleological orientation toward truth, goodness, and beauty. - Curriculum centers the liberal arts (trivium and quadrivium concepts), Great Books, Latin, history in a Western-civilizational frame, and a sense of wonder. - Pedagogy features Socratic discussion, memorization, and oratory, with memory-work and liturgical elements present. - Faculty are framed as virtuous, exemplary teachers who model the curriculum and mentor students; the public content emphasizes character formation and teacher-student partnerships. - Parents & community are central partners, with explicit mention of parent covenant, involvement requirements, book clubs, and family-centered activities.

Citations anchor core evidence to the school's own materials and to the classical elements framework sourced from the knowledge base (see references below).

- Evidence for religious and metaphysical foundations and God-centered pedagogy: Hope Prep emphasizes a God-centered, Christ-centered education, daily worship, Bible, prayer, and a Statement of Faith in public materials. See content describing God-centered or Christ-centered education and Bible integration.
- Evidence for Great Books, Great Conversation, Latin and Trivium-based curriculum: The site describes formal study of Latin, Great Books, Great Conversation, and Trivium elements in its classical framework.
- Evidence for parental involvement and community partnerships: Parental covenant, seven mandatory events, and family engagement are highlighted.
- Evidence for public-facing statements about mission, formation, and virtue: The school articulates formation, virtue, and a teleological aim within a classical Christian frame.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents a God-centered/Christ-centered framework with Scripture at the center, daily worship, Bible study, and a Statement of Faith. - Materials describe a Kingdom-focused, theologically grounded foundation and the central role of God's Word in curriculum and community life. - The religious framing is evident in statements about shepherding hearts, biblical discipline, and worship practices.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: God-centered, Christ-centered, Bible, daily worship, prayer, theology, sacred scripture, creed, worship, liturgy, Word of God, Statement of Faith, kingdom school. - Negative keywords present: none detected in public materials (no explicit appearance of relativism or secular humanism in the sources here).

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: ~7–9 identified directly from the materials cited. - Negative keywords present: 0 identified in the materials cited.

Why this rating - The public materials consistently frame education as a sacred, God-centered enterprise with biblical foundations, worship, and doctrinal statements. This strongly aligns with the Classical element of religious/metaphysical foundations that prioritize transcendental ideals and theology in the formation of character and mind. The evidence supports a CLASSICAL rating for this category.

Citations: God-centered references and daily worship appear in the Classical Christian Education overview and related pages. ; Statement of Faith and doctrinal grounding are available publicly.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom, the pursuit of true, good, and beautiful, and a liberal-arts orientation (paideia, classical mission). The Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis supports this teleological aim. - Materials describe forming leaders through a classical Christian framework and preparing students for college, all within a virtuous formation narrative; the Great Conversation is explicitly referenced.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, true/good/beautiful, liberal education, paideia, great conversation, classic mission, telos. - Negative keywords present: absence of explicit emphasis on purely vocational outcomes or 21st-century job-readiness signals in the public content.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: ~6–7. - Negative keywords present: 0.

Why this rating - Public materials frame education as formation toward human excellence and virtue, with a teleological orientation toward truth, goodness, and beauty, rather than mere job preparation. This aligns with CLASSICAL criteria for purpose and goal.

Citations: Formation and virtue/wisdom statements and Great Books/Great Conversation articulation are present in the Philosophy of Education and What is Classical Christian Education pages.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum explicitly anchors in liberal arts: grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin from early grades; Great Books; discussion of history within the curriculum; Western civilization framing. - The school notes a classical curriculum including Latin, music, art, hands-on science, and library science; study of Great Books and the Great Conversation of history is described. - The Scope & Sequence materials illustrate Bible/phonics, literature, Latin, handwriting, etc., consistent with a classical approach.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, trivium, quadrivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, Great Conversation, Latin, Greek, Western civilization, history, primary sources, recitation/narration, dictation, hymns, sacred art. - Negative keywords present: absence of “social studies” framing or heavy emphasis on project-based learning dominating curriculum.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: ~7–9. - Negative keywords present: 0.

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on the seven liberal arts through Trivium/Quadrivium, Latin, Great Books, and history anchored in Western civilization aligns solidly with CLASSICAL curriculum criteria.

Citations: Liberal arts scaffolding and Great Books are described in the classical education content.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogical descriptions emphasize Socratic discussion, memory-focused recitation, and rhetoric training; lower- and upper-school approaches include singing, memory work, and debates. The material notes that upper grades use seminars and rhetorical training; lower grades include singing and chant to deepen memory. [filecite turn7file? - The site references a balanced approach: contemplative/restful elements and rigorous instruction, aligning with scholé and contemplative learning.](#)

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic discussions, oral presentations, mnemonic devices, chanting/singing to memorize, narration, recitation, progymnasmata, memory work, liturgical/calendar integration, seminars, rhetoric training, public speaking, oratory, debate. - Negative keywords present: no explicit signals of project-based-only or purely experiential learning being emphasized; public content does not foreground those non-classical signals.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: ~6–8. - Negative keywords present: 0.

Why this rating - The pedagogy aligns with classical pedagogy signals (Socratic seminars, memory work, rhetoric, recitation, and structured memory-based learning) and also includes controlled contemplative/restful moments, consistent with scholé.

Citations: Socratic discussions and memory-based pedagogy described in Great Books content; lower- and upper-school practices are reflected in the classical education pages.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty are described as Christian teachers modeling virtue and character, with the public-facing materials emphasizing a living curriculum and teacher-student mentorship; leadership pages present the school as a community of teachers and leaders guided by faith. - The team pages describe leaders and faculty in terms of mission, virtue, and spiritual formation, aligning with classical staff norms.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Christ-centered teachers, model virtue, living curriculum, faculty as the core of the school, mentor-teacher model, character formation. - Negative keywords present: none identified in the public content.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: ~4–5. - Negative keywords present: 0.

Why this rating - The public materials consistently frame teachers as virtuous exemplars who form the core of the curriculum and mentor students, in keeping with classical education expectations for the faculty.

Citations: Faculty and staff descriptions are present in Our Story/Philosophy and Our Team pages.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnering with parents and notes parent covenant requirements, seven mandatory events per year, and parental involvement as foundational to education. Public materials describe parent formation, book clubs, seminars, and a family/community partnership ethos. - Tours, open campus, and frequent opportunities for parent engagement are described, reflecting a strong open-campus ethos.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parents as co-teachers, parent formation, reading groups, seminars, classical book clubs, open campus, volunteer, parent covenant, family involvement, home and school connection. - Negative keywords present: none identified.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: ~6–7. - Negative keywords present: 0.

Why this rating - The materials portray an intentional, front-and-center partnership with families, with explicit parental formation, covenant, and co-educator roles—core signals of a classical community orientation.

Citations: Partnership with families and parent covenant language; parent involvement: turn1file4; Tours/open campus: turn1file2; Our Story language about working with parents: turn0file1.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable here because the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL. No substantial needle-moving changes are required to reach a fully classical standing across the rubric.
-

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.